

	Document Type:	Document Code	RES- CR-01
	DOCUMENTED INFORMATION ISO 9001:2015	Revision No.	00
	Document Title:	Effective Date	
	COMPLETED RESEARCH	Page	Page 1 of 8

(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title: Personal and Cultural Orientation of Ati Students: Its Relationship to their Academic Performance	
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(5) Classification <table> <tr> <td>Research:</td> <td>Development:</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☒ Basic</td> <td>☐ Pilot Testing</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☐ Applied</td> <td>☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization</td> </tr> </table>		Research:	Development:	☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing	☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	(6) Mode of Implementation ☒ Single Authorship/Proponent ☐ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)	
Research:	Development:								
☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing								
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	Document Type:	Document Code	RES- CR-01
	DOCUMENTED INFORMATION ISO 9001:2015	Revision No.	00
	Document Title:	Effective Date	
	COMPLETED RESEARCH	Page	Page 2 of 8

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(9A) Abstract

The academic achievement of Ati High School students is a complex issue that requires a comprehensive understanding, particularly regarding their personal and cultural orientation. This study aimed to determine the level of personal and cultural orientation and its relation to academic achievement among indigenous high school students, specifically from the Ati Tribes in Aglalana Integrated School and Bungsuan National High School. The research involved 26 Ati students selected using complete enumeration sampling. The study used descriptive correlation method and used an adopted questionnaire to gather the data.

The study found that the respondents had a high level of personal and cultural orientation, which was satisfactory for their academic achievement. There were no significant differences in personal and cultural orientation based on grade level, age, sex, mother's educational attainment, father's educational attainment, and monthly family income. However, significant differences in academic performance were observed based on grade level, age, and monthly family income. The study also revealed no significant relationship between personal and cultural orientation and academic achievement.

It is imperative for educators and policymakers to take intentional steps toward creating environments that celebrate cultural diversity. By embedding cultural identity into educational frameworks, institutions can cultivate supportive spaces conducive to personal growth and academic achievement. A commitment to fostering an appreciation for diverse cultures not only benefits individual students but also promotes a richer, more inclusive society where every voice is valued.

(9B) Keywords

cultural orientation, academic achievement, Ati students

Introduction

Education has always been of prime importance to most Filipino families. Parents believe that it is the only way to a successful life and the most invaluable legacy they can pass on to their children. It is the fervent dream of every parent for their children to graduate. Learning performance is determined by several factors, such as social position, home or school environment, and personal factors. However, the quest for education entails a great amount of determination, hard work, and perseverance, especially for underprivileged Filipinos. The ever-escalating cost of education poses a serious problem. The Philippines is home to approximately 110 Indigenous people's communities, with an approximate population of 15 to 20 million. More than 60% reside in Mindanao, 30% in Luzon, and 10% in Visayas. While varying in ways of life and cultural heritage, they share similar experiences of discrimination and marginalization. The situation of other marginalized sectors of society, like the indigenous cultural communities, puts them at an even greater disadvantage. Education cost is not their only problem; they also contend with the mainstream culture they have inevitably integrated with (Gonzales, 2004).

Indigenous communities have assimilated a culture different from that of mainstream society (Kelly & Fitzsimons, 2002). They are the product of a culture developed and evolved by their group. Their patterns of behavior, values, and attitudes are embodied in their frame of reference. Within their community, the level of adjustment and values orientation is high. There is certainty in how they would appropriately respond to their needs, whether physiological or psychological. It is also in this milieu that their sense of belonging could readily contribute to the achievement of their goals in life. They have to adapt to the practices and orientation of the new culture to integrate with it.

Undoubtedly, an abrupt change of environment brings forth confusion, insecurity, and threats to their established personal and cultural orientation. Some may find it difficult and even painful to cope with the current demands or expectations of their adjustment. In such situations, there is a great possibility that stresses, problems, and maladjustment may arise. Considering their different backgrounds, they have to make the necessary adjustments to the environment of which they have eventually become a part. The Ati Filipinos are among the many indigenous peoples (IP) who have experienced devastating destruction of their homes, imposition of settlers in their ancestral domains, and retreats to areas far from basic social

	Document Type:	Document Code	RES- CR-01
	DOCUMENTED INFORMATION ISO 9001:2015	Revision No.	00
	Document Title:	Effective Date	
	COMPLETED RESEARCH	Page	Page 3 of 8

services. Concerning education, the Ati are among those with the lowest literacy rates. It is a challenge to serve their needs in remote areas, and standard education programs fail to take into account their cultures, languages, and current realities.

Hence, the academic achievement of Ati high school students needs to be investigated and understood about their existing level of personal culture so that necessary educational interventions can be facilitated and maximized.

(11) Materials and Methods or Methodology

This descriptive-correlational research, particularly associational, used 26 students enrolled at Aglalana Integrated School and Bungsuan National High School during the School Year 2023-2024 who were selected using complete enumeration sampling.

An adopted questionnaire was used to gather relevant data. The first part consisted of the socio-demographic profile of the respondents, the second part was on the statements on the personal and cultural orientation, and the third part was the academic performance of the respondents during the first semester of School Year 2023-2024. The collected data were encoded in Microsoft Excel and processed in the SPSS software for analysis

(12) Results and Discussions

Mean Level of Personal and Cultural Orientation

Table 1.0 shows the mean level of personal and cultural orientation of the respondents. It was revealed that the respondents got an entire group mean level of 3.5792 with a standard deviation of 0.79376 labeled as “very high”.

Grade 10 and 11 female students aged 16 to 17 years, whose families have a monthly income ranging from Php 1,000 to Php 1,999 had a comparable level of personal and cultural orientation with the rest of the subgroups. Further, both parents of these students attained only an elementary level of education. Despite these challenging circumstances, this subgroup exhibits a comparable level of personal and cultural orientation with their peers from varying socio-economic backgrounds.

The findings suggest that although economic constraints can limit access to resources such as books, extracurricular activities, and educational support systems, they do not inherently stifle the development of personal and cultural identities among adolescents. The resilience displayed by these young females indicates that factors such as community support, peer relationships, and individual aspirations play significant roles in shaping their self-concept and worldview. Consequently, personal identity formation within this demographic appears robust against the backdrop of limited financial means.

Table 1.0 Mean Level of Personal and Cultural Orientation as a Whole and When Grouped According to Socio-demographic Profile.

Socio-demographic Profile	Mean	SD	Interpretation
Entire Group	3.5792	.79376	Very high
Grade Level			
Grade 7	3.4983	.95250	High
Grade 8	3.8525	.15650	High
Grade 9	3.6283	.68277	High
Grade 10	4.3200	.	Very high
Grade 11	3.7720	.99886	High
Grade 12	2.9275	.82334	Moderate
Age			
12-13 years old	3.5700	.81623	High
14-15 years old	3.6300	.60902	High
16-17 years old	3.8383	.90707	High
18 years old and above	3.2120	.95557	Moderate
Sex			
Female	3.8691	.21338	High
Male	3.3667	.98901	Moderate
Mother's Educational Attainment			
Elementary Level	3.9538	.19617	High

	Document Type:	Document Code	RES- CR-01
	DOCUMENTED INFORMATION ISO 9001:2015	Revision No.	00
	Document Title:	Effective Date	
	COMPLETED RESEARCH	Page	Page 4 of 8

High School Level	3.3453	.88273	Moderate
Father's Educational Attainment			
Elementary Level	3.8229	.06726	High
High School Level	3.4895	.91759	High
Monthly Family Income			
Php. 1,000.00-1,999.00	3.9100	.24042	High
Php. 2,000.00-2,999.00	3.7219	.59857	High
Php. 3,000.00-3,999.00	3.0020	1.21568	Moderate
Php. 4,000.00 & Above	3.5600	1.04790	High

Mean Level of Academic Performance

Table 2.0 revealed the mean level of academic performance of the respondents. It was revealed that the respondents got an entire group mean level of 83.0385 with a standard deviation of 2.86330 inferred as "satisfactory".

It was observed that Grade 11 and 12 students, particularly those aged 16 years and above, exhibit a higher level of academic achievement despite varying family income levels and parental educational backgrounds. Specifically, male students hailing from families with a monthly income of Php 4,000 or above and whose parents have attained only a high school education demonstrate comparable academic performance to their peers. This phenomenon invites further exploration into the dynamics of educational equity and the multifaceted influences that contribute to student success.

The implications of these findings are significant as they challenge traditional notions that posit higher family income and parental education as primary determinants of student performance. The fact that male students from lower-income households can achieve similar academic results suggests that factors such as personal motivation, peer influence, school environment, and access to resources may play critical roles in shaping educational outcomes. Moreover, this evidence underscores the importance of fostering supportive learning environments that can empower all students regardless of their socioeconomic status.

Table 2.0 Mean Level of Academic Performance as a Whole and When Grouped According to Socio-demographic Profile.

Socio-demographic Profile	Mean	SD	Interpretation
Entire Group	83.0385	2.86330	Satisfactory
Grade Level			
Grade 7	83.3333	1.36626	Satisfactory
Grade 8	80.7500	.95743	Satisfactory
Grade 9	80.6667	1.75119	Satisfactory
Grade 10	83.0000	.	Satisfactory
Grade 11	85.8000	2.94958	Very satisfactory
Grade 12	85.0000	3.36650	Very satisfactory
Age			
12-13 years old	82.7500	1.66905	Satisfactory
14-15 years old	80.7143	1.60357	Satisfactory
16-17 years old	84.6667	3.61478	Satisfactory
18 years old and above	84.8000	2.94958	Satisfactory
Sex			
Female	82.0000	2.09762	Satisfactory
Male	83.8000	3.16679	Satisfactory
Mother's Educational Attainment			
Elementary Level	81.6250	1.18773	Satisfactory
High School Level	83.2353	2.68164	Satisfactory
Father's Educational Attainment			
Elementary Level	81.7143	1.25357	Satisfactory
High School Level	83.5263	3.15116	Satisfactory
Monthly Family Income			
Php. 1,000.00-1,999.00	80.5000	.70711	Satisfactory

	Document Type:	Document Code	RES- CR-01
	DOCUMENTED INFORMATION ISO 9001:2015	Revision No.	00
	Document Title:	Effective Date	
	COMPLETED RESEARCH	Page	Page 5 of 8

Php. 2,000.00-2,999.00	81.8750	2.02896	Satisfactory
Php. 3,000.00-3,999.00	85.0000	1.22474	Very satisfactory
Php. 4,000.00 & Above	87.6667	3.05505	Very satisfactory

Difference on the Level of Personal and Cultural Orientation as to Socio-demographic Profile

Table 3.0 shows the difference on the level of personal and cultural orientation when classified according to socio-demographic profile of the respondents. The study found no significant differences in personal and cultural orientation based on grade level, age, sex, mother's educational attainment, father's educational attainment and monthly family income.

Table 3.0 Difference on the Level of Personal and Cultural Orientation as to Socio-demographic Profile.

Socio-demographic Profile	Mean	Statistical Test	Sig	Interpretation
Grade Level				
Grade 7	3.4983	Independent Samples Kruskal-Wallis Test	0.473	Retain the null hypothesis
Grade 8	3.8525			
Grade 9	3.6283			
Grade 10	4.3200			
Grade 11	3.7720			
Grade 12	2.9275			
Age				
12-13 years old	3.5700	Independent Samples Kruskal-Wallis Test	0.594	Retain the null hypothesis
14-15 years old	3.6300			
16-17 years old	3.8383			
18 years old and above	3.2120			
Sex				
Female	3.8691	Independent Samples Mann-Whitney U test	0.134	Retain the null hypothesis
Male	3.3667			
Mother's Educational Attainment				
Elementary Level	3.9538	Independent Samples Kruskal-Wallis Test	0.083	Retain the null hypothesis
High School Level	3.3453			
Father's Educational Attainment				
Elementary Level	3.8229	Independent Samples Mann-Whitney U test	0.866	Retain the null hypothesis
High School Level	3.4895			
Monthly Family Income				
Php. 1,000.00-1,999.00	3.9100	Independent Samples Kruskal-Wallis Test	0.836	Retain the null hypothesis
Php. 2,000.00-2,999.00	3.7219			
Php. 3,000.00-3,999.00	3.0020			
Php. 4,000.00 & Above	3.5600			

Difference on the Level of Academic Performance as to Socio-demographic Profile

Table 4.0 shows the difference on the level of academic performance when classified according to socio-demographic profile of the respondents. The study found no significant differences in academic performance based on sex, mother's educational attainment and father's educational attainment. However, significant differences in academic performance were observed based on grade level, age, and monthly family income.

Findings of Khadka et. al. (2022) entails that family economic backgrounds and parental education had a role to play in the academic achievement while cultural factors such as relative lack of predisposition towards education and aspiration for different occupations were the most important factors influencing lower learning performance.

The study of Farooq et. al. (2011) revealed that socioeconomic status and parents' education have a significant effect on students' overall academic achievement as well as achievement in the subjects

	Document Type:	DOCUMENTED INFORMATION ISO 9001:2015	Document Code	RES- CR-01
			Revision No.	00
	Document Title:	COMPLETED RESEARCH	Effective Date	
			Page	Page 6 of 8

of Mathematics and English. The high and average socioeconomic level affects the performance more than the lower level.

Table 4.0 Difference on the Level of Academic Performance as to Socio-demographic Profile.

Socio-demographic Profile	Mean	Statistical Test	Sig	Decision
Grade Level				
Grade 7	83.3333			
Grade 8	80.7500			
Grade 9	80.6667	Independent Samples Kruskal-Wallis Test	0.015	Reject the null hypothesis
Grade 10	83.0000			
Grade 11	85.8000			
Grade 12	85.0000			
Age				
12-13 years old	82.7500			
14-15 years old	80.7143	Independent Samples Kruskal-Wallis Test	0.03	Reject the null hypothesis
16-17 years old	84.6667			
18 years old and above	84.8000			
Sex				
Female	82.0000	Independent Samples Mann-Whitney U test	0.134	Retain the null hypothesis
Male	83.8000			
Mother's Educational Attainment				
Elementary Level	81.6250	Independent Samples Kruskal-Wallis Test	0.085	Retain the null hypothesis
High School Level	83.2353			
Father's Educational Attainment				
Elementary Level	81.7143	Independent Samples Mann-Whitney U test	0.169	Retain the null hypothesis
High School Level	83.5263			
Monthly Family Income				
Php. 1,000.00-1,999.00	80.5000			
Php. 2,000.00-2,999.00	81.8750	Independent Samples Kruskal-Wallis Test	0.004	Reject the null hypothesis
Php. 3,000.00-3,999.00	85.0000			
Php. 4,000.00 & Above	87.6667			

Relationship between personal and cultural orientation and academic performance of the respondents

Table 5.0 shows the relationship between the personal and cultural orientation and academic performance of Ati students. The data revealed that there was no significant relationship between academic performance and personal and cultural orientation ($\alpha = 0.895$). It implies that the personal culture had nothing to do with the academic performance of the Ati respondents. Therefore, the personal and cultural orientation does not affect the academic performance.

Mabin (2016) recognizes that minority students are still struggling to keep pace academically with their peers. In addition, minority students perceive better student-teacher connection with teachers that look like them. Students need inspirational adults that they can connect with, that help them visualize a future for themselves where they are a working professional, find fulfillment in their lives, and changing the cycle of poverty for their families.

The findings of Dev (2016) revealed that academic achievement of elementary school students may be due to fairly good home environment and interest of the students in the studies. Arteaga et. al. (2014) stated that in the light of the fact that school enrolment does not always mean school attendance, much less learning, particularly for indigenous children, policymakers need research that specifies which strategies are most effective for increasing years of completed schooling and increasing the learning that takes place during those years.

Moreover, the findings of the study of Dahal (2013) exposed that it is important for teachers to help students experience a feeling of belongingness in their classrooms. When students feel that they belong, they are more helping, more considerate of others, and more accepting of others, including those not in the friendship group. And Jensen (2009) author of Teaching with Poverty in Mind stated, "What you

	Document Type:	Document Code	RES- CR-01
	DOCUMENTED INFORMATION ISO 9001:2015	Revision No.	00
	Document Title:	Effective Date	
	COMPLETED RESEARCH	Page	Page 7 of 8

want to emphasize at school is moderate social status and group acceptance” (p.90). He went on to emphasize the importance of developing a sense of community within the classroom stating, students who know, trust, and cooperate with one another typically do better academically and that students who feel accepted, have sufficient social status, and maintain positive relationships.

Table 5.0 Relationship between Personal and Cultural Orientation and Academic Performance

Correlations		Academic Performance	Personal and Cultural Orientation
Spearman's rho	Correlation Coefficient	1.000	-.027
	Academic Performance Sig. (2-tailed)	.	.895
	N	26	26
	Correlation Coefficient	-.027	1.000
Personal and Cultural Orientation	Sig. (2-tailed)	.895	.
	N	26	26

(13) Conclusions

1. The findings indicate a notable trend in the personal and cultural orientation among respondents, this suggests that despite varying backgrounds and socio-economic conditions, students in this demographic exhibit a strong inclination towards their cultural identity. Such data provides valuable insights into the resilience and adaptability of young Ati individuals as they navigate their formative years.
2. The statistical representation categorizes the academic performance as “Satisfactory.” Such result indicates that while the majority of students are performing adequately, there remains room for improvement within the educational framework. The data suggests that a substantial number of students are meeting, but not exceeding, expectations in their academic endeavors.
3. The findings elucidate the variances in cultural orientation among respondents, categorized by factors such as grade level, age, sex, and parental educational attainment. Despite the diversity inherent in these demographics, the study concluded that there were no significant differences in personal and cultural orientation across these classifications. Such findings prompt a critical analysis of how deeply ingrained cultural values may transcend demographic boundaries.
4. Certain variables such as sex, and parents’ educational attainment do not significantly influence academic achievement. These demographic factors may not play a critical role in determining students’ academic success within the context of this specific cohort. Conversely, the study highlights significant differences in academic performance when classified according to grade level, age, and monthly family income. This underscores the importance of these variables in shaping educational experiences and outcomes. Age may correlate with maturity and cognitive development, factors critical to learning efficacy.
5. The lack of a significant relationship between personal and cultural orientation and academic achievement implies that factors other than personal culture may play a more critical role in shaping

	Document Type:	DOCUMENTED INFORMATION ISO 9001:2015	Document Code	RES- CR-01
			Revision No.	00
	Document Title:	COMPLETED RESEARCH	Effective Date	
			Page	Page 8 of 8

academic success for Ati students. This could include variables such as socioeconomic status, access to educational resources, teaching quality, and parental support.

Recommendations

1. It is recommended that educators and policymakers take proactive measures to foster an environment that celebrates and integrates cultural identity within educational frameworks. By promoting awareness and appreciation for diverse cultures, institutions can create supportive spaces that enhance students' self-esteem and academic performance;
2. Educators may integrate varied pedagogical approaches and styles to ensure that Ati students have the opportunity not only to meet but also to exceed expectations in their academic journeys; and
3. Future studies related to this may be conducted.

(14) Output

Baseline information for the study of personal and cultural orientation and its relationship on academic performance of Ati students.

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Conducted (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes, or services transferred as extension activities)

(16) Economic Analysis (This should present the direct cost of project implementation, expenses in the production of technology, revenues generated from technology produced, return on investment (ROI) and payback period.

(17) Acknowledgments (Include only important persons and institutions with involvement in funding and conduct of the research. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

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